

Project 1: Uncanny Valley

Proposal

For this project, I will explore the idea of the uncanny valley through the visual language of Pokémon cards. I'm interested in how a format that is normally playful, collectible, and nostalgic can become unsettling when its familiar elements are altered, distorted, or pushed toward realism. By taking a system that people recognize instantly—bright colors, simplified anatomy, friendly expressions, predictable layouts—and nudging it toward something almost human, almost biological, or almost emotionally readable, I want to expose the tension between comfort and discomfort that defines the uncanny. I'm especially drawn to the way Pokémon designs balance cuteness with creature-ness. When that balance shifts—when eyes become too glassy, skin becomes too textured, proportions become too close to human or too close to animal—the viewer feels a subtle wrongness. That “almost but not quite” sensation is what I want to amplify. I plan to experiment with hyper-real shading, mismatched textures, distorted anatomy, and eerie micro-expressions that break the expected charm of the original characters. Even small changes, like a smile that's too wide or a limb that bends slightly incorrectly, can destabilize the viewer's sense of safety. At the same time, the card format itself offers opportunities for uncanniness. The rigid border, the stats, the move descriptions, the energy symbols—they all create a sense of order. When that order glitches, warps, or contradicts itself, the card becomes a site of unease. I want to explore how corrupted metadata, unsettling move names, or warped typographic hierarchy can make the card feel like an artifact from a world that's familiar but fundamentally off.

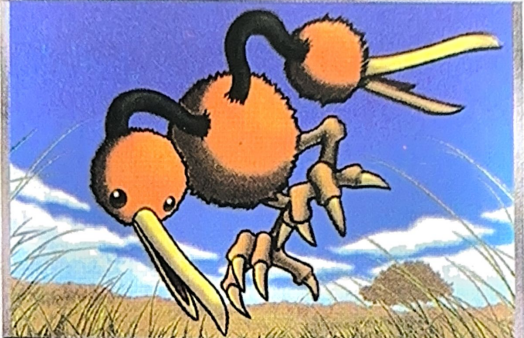
References



BASIC

Doduo

HP 70



NO. 084 Twin Bird Pokémon HT: 4'07" WT: 86.4 lbs.

*** Double Hit

30x

Flip 2 coins. This attack does 30 damage times the number of heads.

weakness



x2

resistance



-20

retreat



A two-headed Pokémon that was discovered as a sudden mutation. It runs at a pace of over 60 miles per hour.

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BASIC

Jirachi^{EX}

HP 90



Ability Stellar Guidance

When you play this Pokémon from your hand onto your Bench, you may search your deck for a Supporter card, reveal it, and put it into your hand. Shuffle your deck afterward.



Hypnostrike

60

Both this Pokémon and the Defending Pokémon are now Asleep.

weakness



x2

resistance



-20

retreat



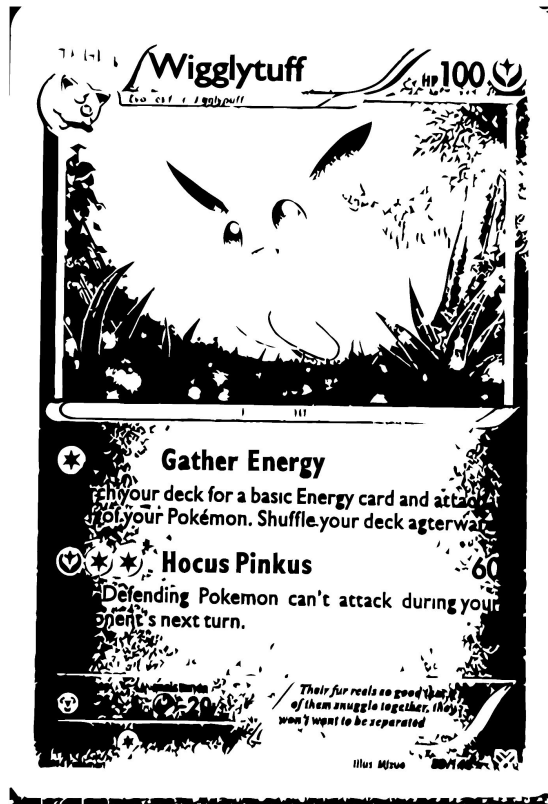
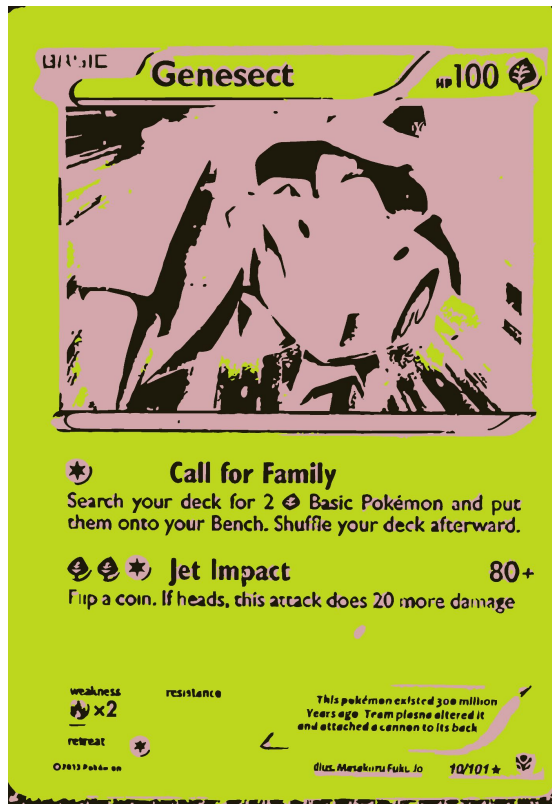
Pokémon-EX rule

When a Pokémon-EX has been Knocked Out, your opponent takes 2 Prize cards.

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Drafts



Final

